

Cybersecurity Escape Room

Crack 4 puzzles to unlock the final code and 'escape' the hacker's trap



MIDDLE
SCHOOL

HIGH
SCHOOL

20-30 MIN

TEAMS OF
2-4

The Story

Your team just discovered that a hacker has locked the school's smart traffic control system! To regain access, you must solve 4 cybersecurity puzzles. Each one gives you a single digit. Collect all 4 digits, put them in order, and unlock the system on the final page before time runs out!

How to play: Work in teams. Each puzzle below is worth one digit of a 4-digit code. Write your digit in the box as you solve each one. A timer of 20-30 minutes works well, but it's not required.

Puzzle 1 — The Coded Message

Hackers sometimes hide instructions in scrambled text. This message was encoded with a **Caesar cipher**, every letter is shifted forward by 3 in the alphabet (A becomes D, B becomes E, and so on). Shift each letter *back* by 3 to decode it.

WKH FRGH LV VHYHQ

Decoded message: _____

The decoded message spells out a number. That number's **last digit** is Digit #1.

DIGIT #1:

Puzzle 2 — Spot the Phishing Email

One of these 4 sender addresses is legitimate. The other three are phishing attempts. Find the real one.

#	Sender Address
1	security@school-district.net
2	security@school-district.org

3	security-team@schooldistrict-verify.com
4	schooldistrict@security-alert.info

Which number is the real address? That number is Digit #2.

DIGIT #2:



Keep Solving!

Puzzle 3 — Rank the Passwords

Rank these four passwords from WEAKEST (1) to STRONGEST (4).

A — sunshine Rank: ____

B — Tr@ff!c\$1gn@l_24 Rank: ____

C — 12345678 Rank: ____

D — MyDog2020 Rank: ____

Take the rank you gave to password **B**. That number is Digit #3.

DIGIT #3:

Puzzle 4 — The Final Riddle

Riddle

"I sit buried under the road, and I never make a sound. I don't see colors, I don't hear cars, but I always know when one is around. When a car sits on top of me, I tell the signal it's time to change. What am I?"

Answer: _____ (hint: it's a vocabulary word from this project!)

Count the letters in your answer. The **last digit** of that count is Digit #4.

DIGIT #4:

Crack the Final Code!

Enter your four digits in order to unlock the system:

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Facilitator Answer Key

Digit 1: 7 (from 'THE CODE IS SEVEN') · Digit 2: 2 (school-district.org is the only legitimate domain, no misspellings or suspicious extensions) · Digit 3: 4 (B is the strongest password and should be ranked 4th) · Digit 4: depends on answer length for 'INDUCTION LOOP' (13 letters, no spaces) -> Digit 4 = 3. **Full code: 7243**

